Dear Editor,

Thank you for the opportunity to revise our manuscript **ASOC-D-25-13526**, entitled "Optimization of Empty Container Repositioning by Integrating Large Language Models and Multi-Agent Systems." We greatly appreciate the constructive and thorough comments from all three reviewers, which have substantially improved the quality of our manuscript.

We have carefully addressed every comment. The major revisions include:

- **Clarified the anomaly backtracking mechanism** (Reviewers 1 & 3): We rewrote Section 3.2 to explicitly distinguish the Failure Detection stage from the PM-Agent-led exception backtracking procedure, with step-by-step worked examples illustrating both with-TE-Agent and without-TE-Agent scenarios.
- **Added formulation stability experiments** (Reviewers 1 & 2): A new Section 5.3 reports `top_p` ablation on benchmark datasets, and Section 5.4 introduces the Structural-Agreement Rate (SAR) metric with experiments on a complex empirical ECR instance, revealing that constraint-level variability dominates token-level sampling effects.
- **Corrected terminology, notation, and figures** (Reviewer 3): Fixed dual-use of variable i, undefined symbols in Equation (1), variable inconsistencies in Figure 1, the incorrect problem instance in Figure 2, and all formatting inconsistencies throughout.
- **Discussed limitations and future directions** (Reviewers 1 & 3): Added an explicit discussion of multi-agent interaction latency, the absence of a human baseline for modeling time, and expanded future research directions in the Conclusion.

A detailed point-by-point response to all reviewer comments is provided in the accompanying Response Letter.

We believe the revised manuscript has been significantly strengthened and hope it is now suitable for publication in *Applied Soft Computing*.

Sincerely,

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